Inspection Report

University of North Texas Health Science Center

3500 Camp Bowie Blvd
FORT WORTH, TX 76107

Customer ID: **1502**

Certificate: **74-R-0081**

Site: 001
UNIVERSITY OF NORTH TEXAS HEALTH SCIENCE CENTER

Type: FOCUSED INSPECTION

Date: 29-SEP-2026

2.31(c)(7)

Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC).

A significant deviation from protocol occurred when adult pig 44452 under study unexpectedly died on 16 June 2026 and no necropsy was performed. The protocol states that in the event of unexpected death of an animal, actions undertaken include a necropsy. When the inspector asked to see the necropsy report of pig 44452, the Attending Veterinarian confirmed that in fact no diagnostic necropsy or diagnostic report was performed. Furthermore, after interviewing facility staff, it was determined that the necropsy referred to in the self-report letters to the Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC) and to the Office of Laboratory Animal Welfare was a misnomer and the procedure performed immediately post-death was to recover surgical implants only. No written record regarding the recovery of the surgical implants was available for review and the information was provided via memory recall to the inspector.

This activity constitutes a significant deviation from the approved activities in the protocol. Making significant changes to protocols without IACUC review and approval deprives the IACUC of the opportunity to provide oversight of animal activities and compliance with the Animal Welfare Act.

Principal investigators are to follow the IACUC approved protocols, and any proposed changes shall be reviewed and approved by the IACUC prior to implementation. Those carrying out procedures in an IACUC-approved protocol must adhere to what was approved by the IACUC. Corrected prior to inspection by development of a standard operating procedure regarding mortality review for unexpected deaths of animals and necropsy form.

3.125(a) **Critical**

Facilities, general.

On 16 June 2026, adult pig 44452 unexpectedly died within the 10 day post-operative window (underwent thoracic surgery) when the non-surgical adult pigs housed directly adjacent to it gained access to the surgical pig's enclosure through a clear hard plastic divider with a malfunctioning latch. The facility reports that the surgical animal experienced internal vascular injury (from catheter displacement from animal interaction) and abrupt death before intervention could be provided. Subsequent internal review and risk mitigation procedures such as adding a secondary locking mechanism, implementing monthly enclosure inspections by facility management, creation of a surgical pig separation checklist and alternating empty stalls between surgical animals and other animals have resulted in no unwanted pairing of animals

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Date: 02-OCT-2026

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since the primary incident.

Failure to construct facilities of such strength as appropriate for the animals involved or maintain them in good repair can result in serious injury or death of animals. The indoor housing facilities shall be structurally sound and maintained in good repair to protect the animals from injury and to contain the animals. Corrected prior to inspection.

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with the facility representatives.

You may appeal all or part of any inspection report by submitting a written statement contesting the findings—along with any supporting documentation—to the Deputy Administrator. Appeals of routine, focused, or attempted inspections must be received within 21 days of report issuance as shown by the signature line of this report.

Appeals may be sent by email to AnimalCare@usda.gov.

Appeals sent by mail should be addressed to:
Deputy Administrator
APHIS Animal Care (AC)
U.S. Department of Agriculture
2150 Centre Avenue, Building B
Mailstop #3W11
Fort Collins, CO 80526-8117

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United States Department of Agriculture
Animal and Plant Health Inspection Service

Customer: 1502
Inspection Date: 29-Sep-2026

Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
1502	74-R-0081	001	UNIVERSITY OF NORTH TEXAS HEALTH SCIENCE CENTER	29-SEP-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000004	*Sus scrofa domestica*	DOMESTIC PIG / POTBELLY PIG / MICRO PIG
000004	**Total**	